

News

DRIVING CHANGE TOGETHER: MARYLAND'S ALL-IN APPROACH TO CLEAN TRANSPORTATI ON

Maryland members of the *America Is All In* coalition are reshaping the state's transportation future by championing policies that reduce pollution, cut commuter costs, and expand transit options.

By [Miguel Moravec](#)

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Transportation is the number one source of greenhouse gas emissions in both the State of Maryland and in the larger United States. Not only does tailpipe pollution contribute to heat-trapping climate change, but it also threatens the clean air that Marylanders breathe.

Clean transportation policy is key to addressing these issues and the *America Is All In* coalition is helping drive those policies forward in Maryland. The coalition's unique "all-of-society" approach has been critical to mobilizing support in the Old Line State for proposed bills and an enacted executive order to expand healthy transportation choices for residents and businesses.

“FROM BREAKTHROUGH
ANALYSIS TO IMPACTFUL
CONVENINGS AND COMPELLING
TESTIMONY, OUR MEMBERS

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Photo courtesy of Maryland Sierra Club, which led the advocacy coalition behind the "TCA"

For example, *All In* partners and members were a part of the research, community engagement, and advocacy that spurred the introduction of the Transportation and Climate Alignment (TCA) Act, which would go on to be featured in AP News and to inform Governor Wes Moore's recent executive order on climate solutions.

The bill, first introduced in January 2024, called for expanded investment in public transit, bike and pedestrian infrastructure while also requiring improved accountability for projects that increase pollution and commuter costs.

**ACCORDING TO POLLING BY
THE MD SIERRA CLUB, A
WHOPPING 78% OF
MARYLANDERS SUPPORT**

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MEMBERS ACROSS THE STATE TESTIFIED IN SUPPORT OF CLEANER WAYS TO GET AROUND

From faith groups to main street institutions, Maryland *All In* members were deeply engaged in advocacy calling for clean transportation policy in Annapolis. In fact, multiple members submitted testimony in support of the Transportation and Climate Alignment Act:

The National Aquarium

 “About a third of our staff rely on modes of transport other than individual motor vehicles for commuting to work... modernizing our transportation infrastructure will not only yield positive environmental outcomes, but will improve public health, shorten commutes, and reduce transportation costs for Marylanders.”

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City of Rockville, Maryland

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CENTER FOR GLOBAL SUSTAINABILITY CHARTER THE

You can't manage what you don't measure, which is why the Center for Global Sustainability (CGS) at the University of Maryland partnered with the Maryland Department of the Environment to model a feasible, implementable pathway to achieve Maryland's ambitious climate goals under the Climate Solutions Now Act of 2022. This report was delivered to the state of Maryland and informed the Maryland's [Climate Pollution Reduction Plan](#) released in 2023. CGS, an *All In* coalition partner, completed an economy-wide analysis of the full set of strategies needed to achieve the state's ambitious Climate Solutions Now Act goals.



The front cover of CGS's modeling appendix report.

As a result of the detailed path laid out by CGS, lawmakers in Annapolis [directly cited](#) CGS' model in the Transportation and Climate Alignment Act of 2025 as a way to set annual, data-driven targets for Maryland's Department of Transportation.

RMI DROVE THE CONVERSATION FORWARD WITH COST SAVINGS AND POLICY EXPERTISE

After being cited in [news coverage](#) pointing out that Maryland was behind on its clean transportation goals, *All In* coalition partner RMI testified about the benefits of expanding clean transportation choices through state policy. Using its Smarter MODES tool, RMI found that the average [Maryland household would save over \\$3,000 per year](#) in vehicle fuel, maintenance, and depreciation costs if the state succeeded in achieving its climate and mode shift goals.

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The RMI Smarter MODES Calculator projects the cost-savings and other co-benefits of increased transportation choices. The tool was cited frequently during policy discussions.

Leveraging experience learned in Minnesota, RMI

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CERES MADE THE BUSINESS CASE FOR SUSTAINABLE TRANSPORTATION

Ikea. Nestle. Siemens. These are just a few of the businesses that *All In* coalition partner Ceres brought to the table to support clean transportation strategies in Maryland. After [mobilizing private sector support](#) for the state's clean truck standards which passed in 2023, Ceres convened briefings with local companies and governor's staff to talk about the economic advantages of [climate smart policy](#), including the Transportation and Climate Alignment Act. With many of these policies, such as clean truck standards, being re-considered, it's important now more than ever that Maryland voices from all sectors of society come to the table to defend our climate progress.

GOVERNOR LEADS THE WAY WITH EXECUTIVE ORDER

Carrying forward the momentum generated by the *All In's* all of society approach, Maryland Governor and U.S. Climate Alliance member Wes Moore issued an [executive order](#) advancing several of the key provisions in the proposed Transportation and Climate Alignment Act. These directives included:

 Gov. Moore signs an order advancing Maryland climate priorities, including clean transportation.

Photo courtesy of the Maryland Office of the Governor

In a [press release](#) about the order, Gov. Moore shared “Climate action is about more than avoiding disaster. It’s about growing opportunity.”

Although the executive order advances many important clean transportation priorities, there is still work to be done. Advocates plan to continue fighting for the passage of the full Transportation and Climate Alignment Act in 2026. Even amid challenging headwinds, Maryland members of the *America Is All In* coalition will continue to demonstrate their impact unlocking the benefits of climate smart, affordable transportation choices.

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AMERICA IS ALL IN

America Is All In is the most expansive network of leaders ever assembled in support of climate action in the United States. Mobilizing thousands of U.S. cities, states, tribal nations, businesses, schools, and faith, health, and cultural institutions, the network is working to develop and deliver a subnational climate strategy that meets the urgency of the climate crisis, scaling climate action around the country to empower workers, and communities, and promoting the leadership of non-federal actors on the world stage.

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